

RETAILNEXT X OPENAI

OPENAI-POWERED EVENT SHOPPING ASSISTANT FOR RETAILNEXT.

A natural language assistant that helps shoppers describe what they need, checks real inventory, and carries the journey into web, app, WhatsApp, associate, and email follow-up channels.

CHAT-FIRST

customers ask in natural language or share a photo

STOCK AWARE

SKU, store, size, and price checked before display

CHANNEL READY

same assistant pattern across site, app, WhatsApp, store, and email follow-up

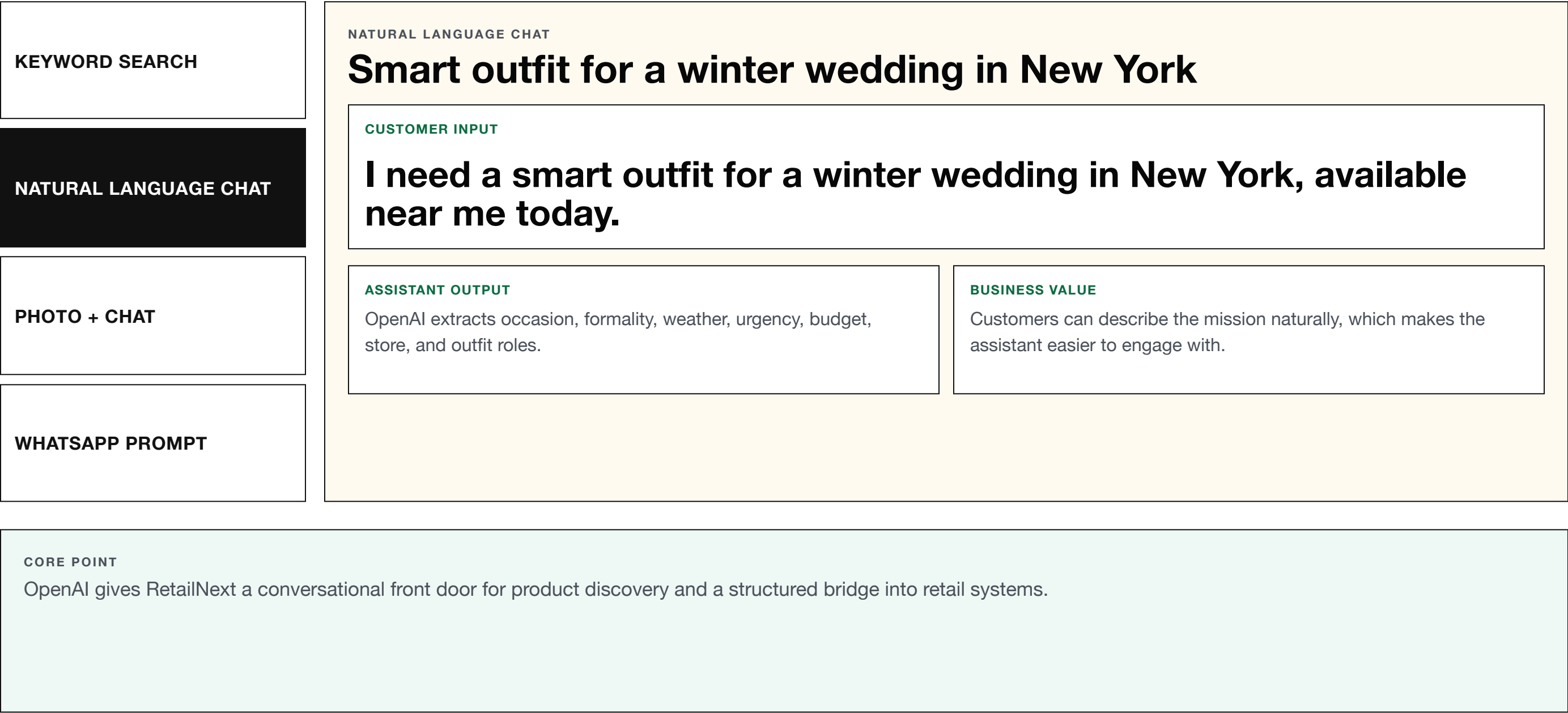
EVENT SHOPPERS STRUGGLE TO FIND OR CONFIRM THE RIGHT ITEMS QUICKLY.

Reviews point to the same issue: discovery, availability, and store confidence are split across the journey.

CUSTOMER Occasion-led demand "I need something for a winter wedding" is a better brief than "black dress".	STORE Availability uncertainty Customers and associates still need to confirm store, size, substitutes, and timing.	BUSINESS High-intent friction Event shoppers have urgency, higher basket potential, and lower tolerance for failed searches.
LOST CONVERSION high-intent shoppers abandon when availability confidence is low	MANUAL LOOKUP associates bridge style, stock, substitutes, and customer messaging	BRAND TRUST poor reviews compound when store discovery falls short of the digital promise

THE INTERFACE MATTERS: CHAT CAPTURES MORE OF THE BUYING MISSION.

Customers are more likely to engage when they can explain the occasion in their own words.



AN INVENTORY-GROUNDED AI ASSISTANT FOR EVENT SHOPPING.

OpenAI interprets text, images, and follow-up chat. RetailNext verifies products, stock, price, and fulfilment.

UNDERSTAND Text, image, occasion, style, budget, store	RETRIEVE Semantic catalogue matches	GROUND SKU, inventory, price, size, fulfilment	CONVERSE Swap, explain, refine, email	ACTIVATE Basket, associate handoff, email follow-up
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OPENAI ROLE

Understand and converse

Intent extraction, image understanding, semantic retrieval inputs, action selection, explanations, and review.

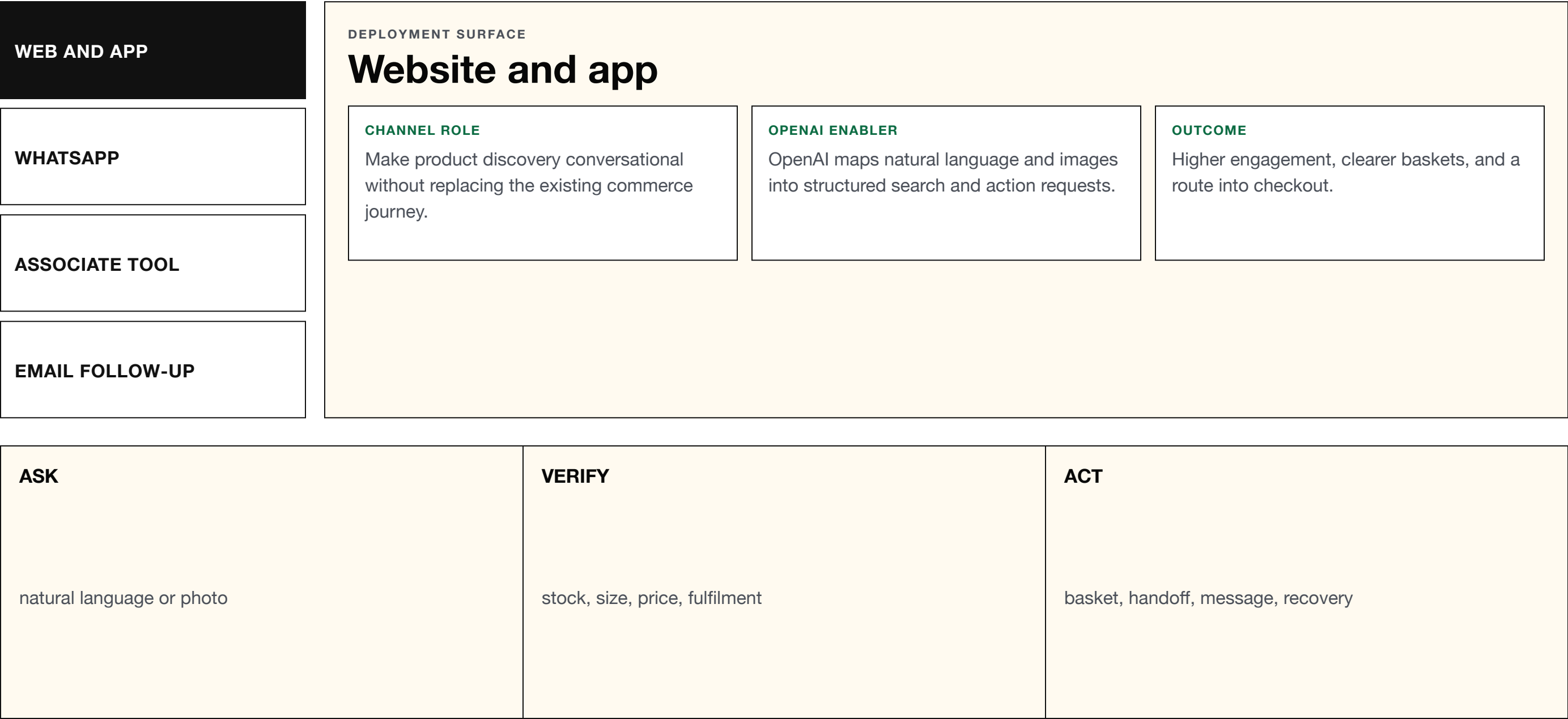
RETAILNEXT ROLE

Control retail decisions

Catalogue SKUs, price, stock, store rules, basket changes, fulfilment, and email delivery.

THE CHATBOT PATTERN CAN SIT WHEREVER CUSTOMERS ALREADY SHOP.

One assistant workflow can serve the website, mobile app, WhatsApp, associates, and lifecycle messaging.



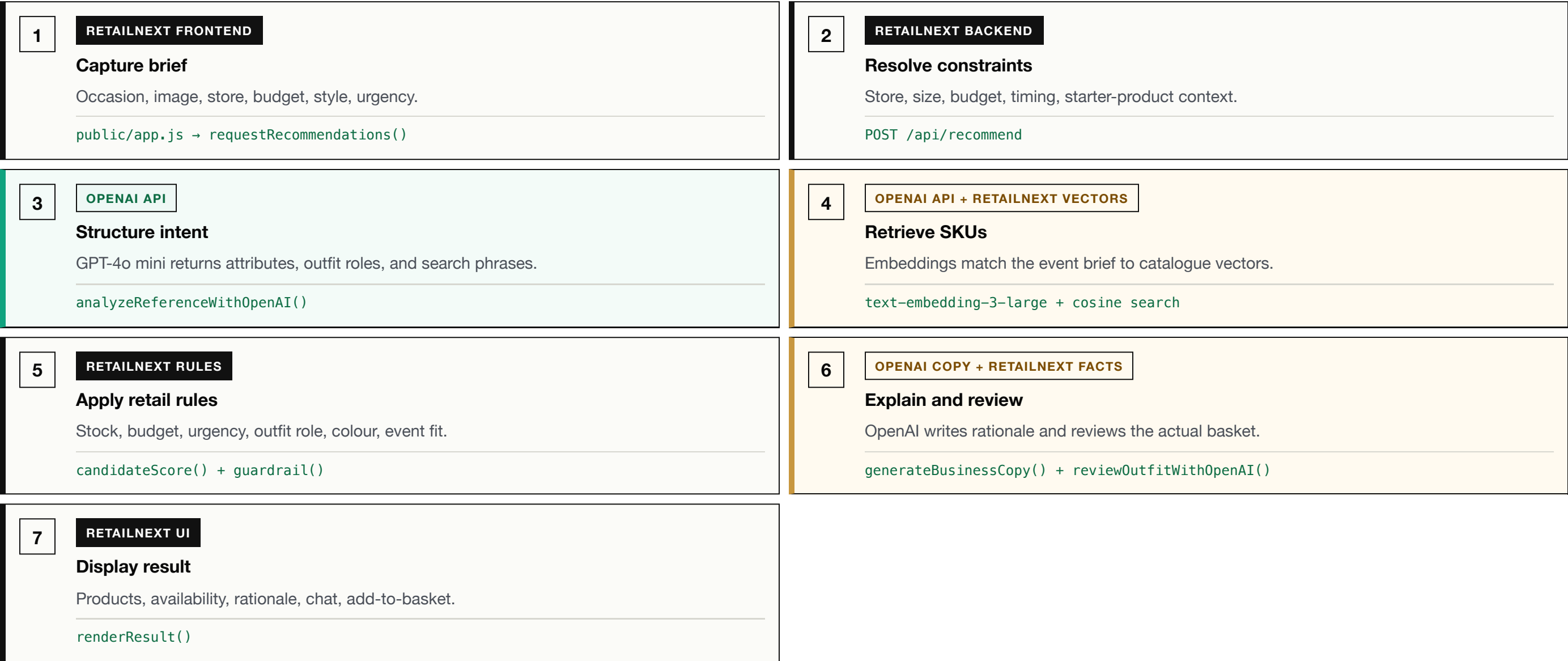
GENERATE OUTFIT: PROPOSE, VERIFY, DISPLAY.

The boundary is simple: OpenAI interprets and explains; RetailNext validates what can be shown and sold.

RETAILNEXT OWNED

OPENAI API

OPENAI + RETAILNEXT

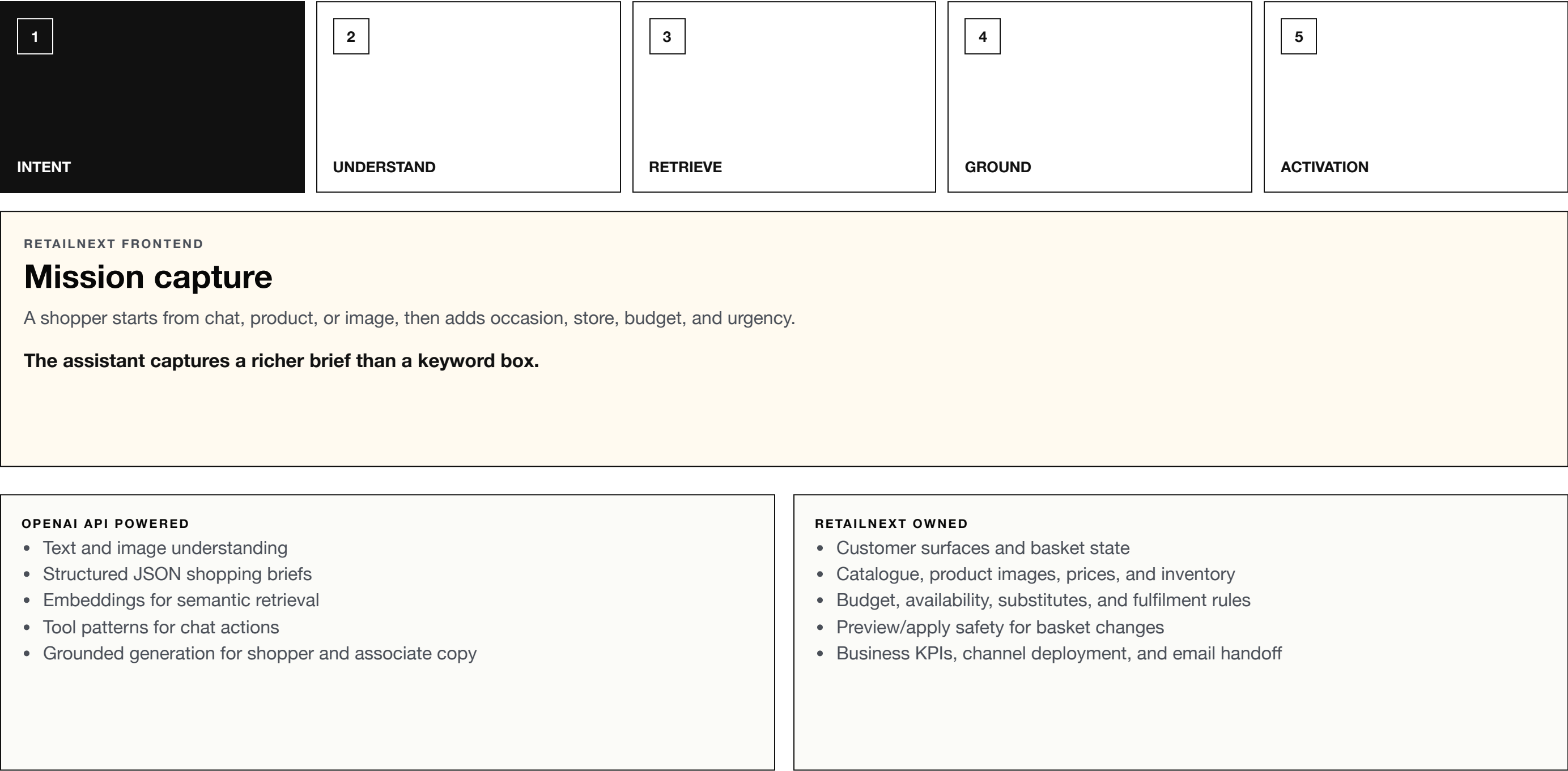


IMPORTANT BOUNDARY

OpenAI never becomes the source of product truth. RetailNext owns catalogue data, price, stock, basket state, and fulfilment rules.

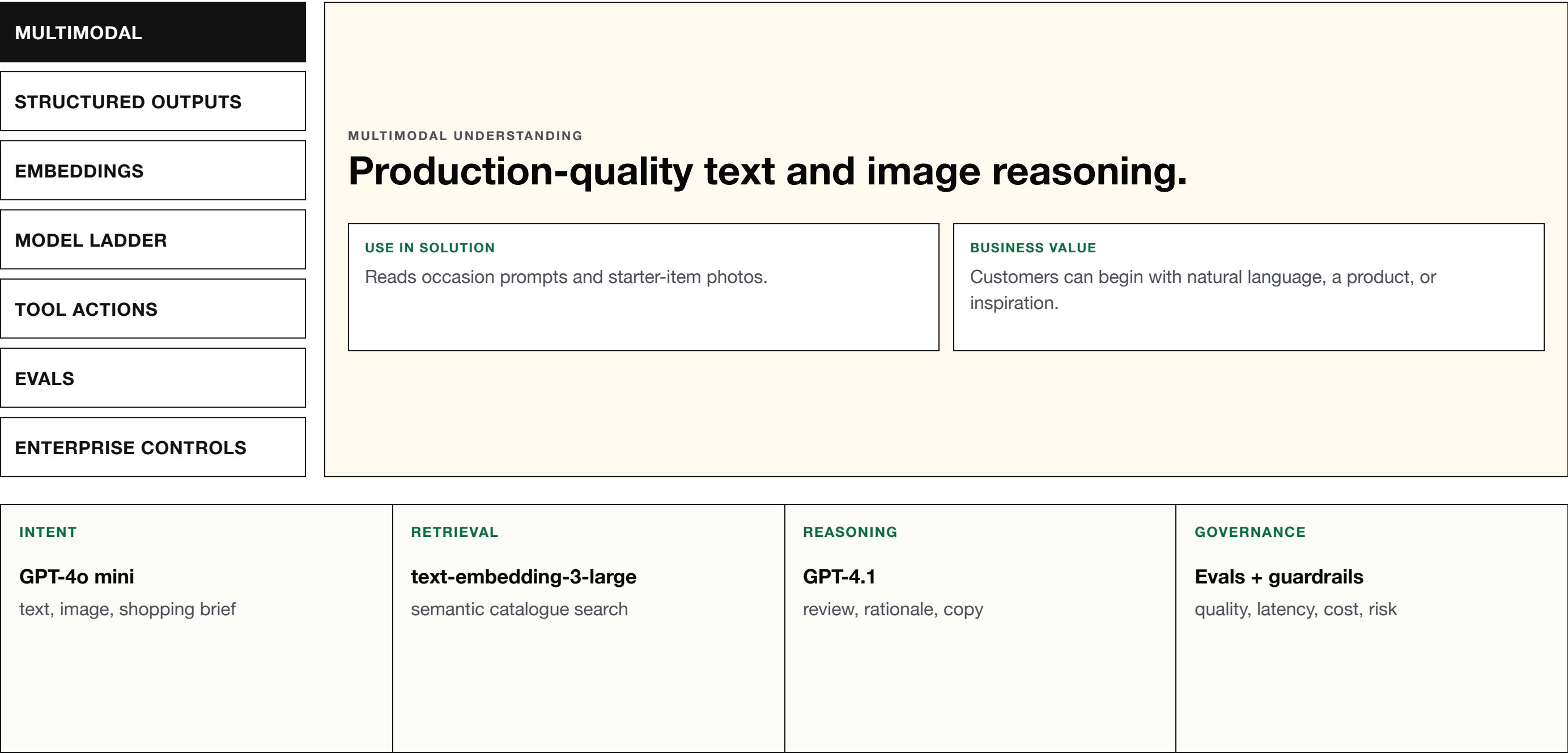
FLEXIBLE CONVERSATION, CONTROLLED RETAIL DECISIONS.

Click through the flow to show the OpenAI and RetailNext boundary.



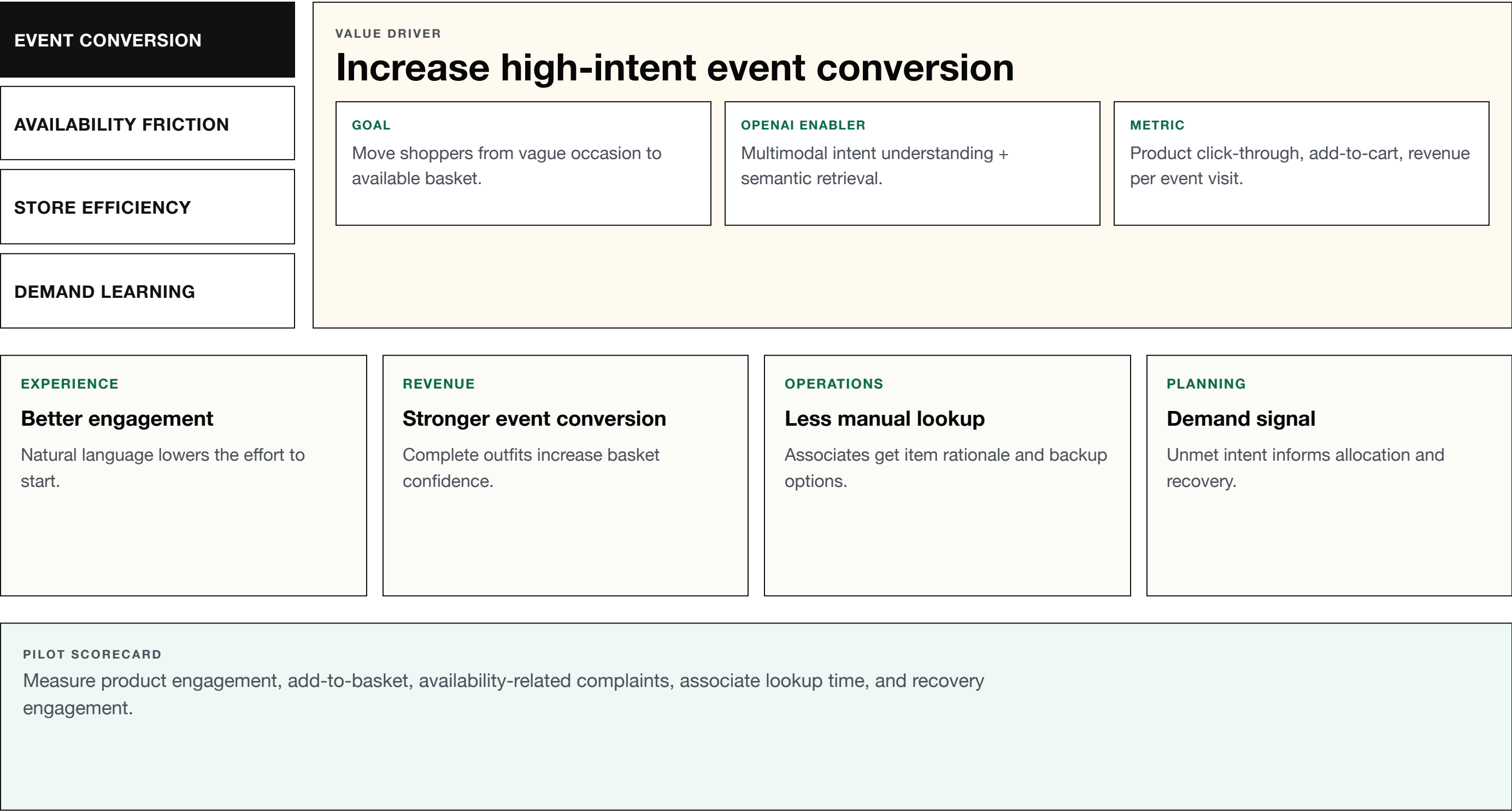
OPENAI IS THE PLATFORM LAYER FOR THE ASSISTANT LOOP.

Multimodal understanding, structured outputs, embeddings, model choice, tool actions, and evals work together in one pattern.



BUSINESS VALUE MAP FOR RETAILNEXT.

Use the value toggle to connect OpenAI capabilities to measurable retail outcomes.



CRAWL, WALK, RUN.

Prove engagement first, then integrate operations and expand channels.

0-8 WEEKS

Crawl

Text assistant, limited categories, selected stores, static inventory snapshot.

2-4 MONTHS

Walk

Photo input, real-time inventory, guardrail tuning, WhatsApp pilot.

SCALE

Run

Associate assistant, email recovery, personalisation, continuous eval loop.

CLOSING LINE

"Start with the customer conversation, ground it in RetailNext inventory, and measure the commercial journey end to end."